



HUMANITAS
INSTITUTE

Six Elements of Classical Education School Website Audit

School: Adelphia Classical Christian Academy

School Website: <https://www.adelphiaclassical.com/>

January 7, 2026

Artificial Intelligence Disclaimer

This audit was performed using artificial intelligence tools to evaluate the presence and strength of classical education principles on school websites. Results are automated, probabilistic in nature, and should be considered indicative rather than definitive. See the full disclaimer in the Appendix more details.

SCL MEMBER

Any school that belongs to the Society for Classical Learning (SCL) is, by definition, recognized as a classical school because SCL requires adherence to the six essential elements defined by the Humanitas Institute. However, a school's website may not clearly reflect its conformity to one or more elements. In such cases, the school may still receive a "Somewhat Classical" rating for those elements. Schools can update their website content at any time to achieve a "Classical" rating for a given element.

Overall Classification: **CLASSICAL**

Executive Summary

Adelphia Classical Christian Academy (ACCA) presents a robust classical-leaning program anchored in a Christ-centered, Biblically grounded framework. Across categories, ACCA demonstrates core classical markers: the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) as developmental stages; a curriculum oriented toward liberal arts, Great Books/Western civilization influences, Latin/Greek preparatory work, and a public emphasis on virtue, truth, beauty, and goodness; pedagogy that includes Socratic discourse alongside memorization, chanting, and memory-work; a faculty described as skilled teachers forming a "living curriculum"; and a strong parent/community partnership through its Private School Program (PSP) structure, which positions parents as collaborators rather than mere customers. Public materials consistently foreground virtues, theological commitments, and a shared ethos (truth, beauty, goodness) and describe structures (CLSA/WASC accreditation, NCAA/UC course approvals) that align with classical aims rather than workforce-aimed curricula.

Overall classification: **CLASSICAL**

Key strengths observed in ACCA's public materials and the crawl content include: explicit Trivium framing and three-stage development, a curriculum that centers Classical core subjects with Memoria Press and other classical resources, Socratic and rhetoric-inflected pedagogy, visible moral formation and prayer/ethos, and a strong parental-partnership model. Some public materials also emphasize a hybrid/home-study component and 3-day on-campus structure, which reflects a distinctive PSP arrangement rather than a traditional 5-day classical school, but the classical core remains front-and-center. This combination sustains the school's alignment with classical aims while leveraging a hybrid delivery model. See evidence excerpts cited below for category-specific justification.

Executive Summary — Element-by-Element Snapshot

Element 1: Religious and Metaphysical Foundations — **CLASSICAL**

Evidence

- The Academy presents itself as Christ-centered and Biblically rooted, stating that it provides a Christ-centered, Classical education firmly rooted in Biblical Truth.
- The Statement of Faith and related pages emphasize doctrinal alignment with Christian faith (Nicene Creed; creedal affirmations; confession of faith; family as a unit in God's plan).
- The motto and ethos pages articulate a "Truth, Beauty, Goodness" framework as a central educational goal and, in several pages, an insistence that God be at the center of education.

- The academy explicitly links moral formation with Christian unity and virtue formation, framing education as formation in a Christian worldview.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Christ-centered; Biblical Truth; Theology; Creed; liturgical/moral language around Truth-Beauty-Goodness; prayer/creedal language; church/community alignment.
- Negative indicators: None evident in public materials (no explicit relativism, hedging, or secular-humanist framing observed in the public text snippets provided).

Why this rating

- ACCA's public materials consistently foreground a theological/humanity-centered, theologically grounded framework. The explicit Christ-centered aim, biblical grounding, and creedal language map squarely onto the "Religious and Metaphysical Foundations" positive keyword set. There are no evident counter-signals in the sources reviewed. Therefore, this category is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Christ-centered/Biblical Truth framing and Statement of Faith are present in the Academics Overview and related Faith sections.

Element 2: School Purpose and Goal — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- ACCA's stated goal centers on Truth, Beauty, and Goodness, and on forming virtue and wisdom rather than vocational training alone (the Great Books/Western civ emphasis, Trivium framing, and virtue formation language). For example, Mission emphasizes cultivating truth, beauty, goodness, and Christian unity toward wisdom and virtue.
- The "Authentic Classical Education" section stresses placing God at the center so that Truth can guide students toward wisdom and virtue.
- The curriculum approach links the Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric) to a lifelong formation in virtue and critical thinking, echoing a paideia-like aim rather than merely job-prep.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: formation, virtue, wisdom; pursuit of Truth, Goodness, Beauty; liberal education/pedagogy aligned with classical aims; Great Conversation/Great Books alignment.
- Negative indicators: None clearly present; ACCA's PSP structure emphasizes college- and NCAA-acceptable courses, but these appear as accreditation/credential supports rather than vocationalization signals.

Why this rating

- ACCA's public materials strongly align with the classical aim of formation of human excellence (virtue and wisdom) rather than a narrow career-prep stance. The explicit emphasis on Truth, Beauty, Goodness, the Trivium, and the Great Books orientation points to CLASSICAL rather than NOT CLASSICAL. The presence of college/UC/NCAA approvals is primarily a credential mechanism and does not negate the core teleology of virtue-formation. Therefore, Element 2 is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Mission emphasizing Truth, Beauty, Goodness; "Authentic Classical Education" statement; Trivium emphasis.

Element 3: School Curriculum — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The curriculum explicitly follows the Trivium (grammar, dialectic/logic, rhetoric) with detailed references to grammar-style early years and logic/rhetoric development, and a high school emphasis on rhetoric and presentation. This is repeatedly described in the program materials and course outlines.
- The program uses Memoria Press materials and Classical Core Curriculum; there is explicit mention of Latin/Greek study and classical literature with an emphasis on Western civilization and Great Books.
- The K–12 program includes core liberal-arts subjects (phonics, reading, writing, grammar, math, history/geography, etc.) and offers university course alignments (UC-a-g and NCAA options) for older students, indicating a rigorous, classical content sequence.
- The curriculum references Great Books and Western civilization as a throughline in the study of Western thought and culture.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Trivium (grammar, logic, rhetoric); Great Books/Great Conversation; liberal arts; Latin/Greek; Western civilization; memorization/chanting/memory-work; classical curriculum (Memoria Press, etc.).
- Negative indicators: The materials do not reflect a heavy “social studies” reframing or predominant project-based-first framing; rather, there is an emphasis on memorization, classical texts, and memory work, which are positive indicators in this framework.

Why this rating

- ACCA's curriculum is clearly rooted in classical content and methods: Trivium structure, classical literature and language study, Great Books orientation, and a focus on Western civilization. The explicit use of Memoria Press and reliance on classical core texts aligns with a CLASSICAL Curriculum. Therefore, Element 3 is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Trivium framing and three-stage development; Memoria Press, Latin/Greek and Great Books references; K–12 core subjects.

Element 4: School Pedagogy or Teaching Methods — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- Pedagogical approach includes the Socratic method for upper levels, with opportunities for seminary-like discourse, debate, and rhetorical exercises. The public materials explicitly call out Socratic discussion and rhetoric/instruction at high school levels.
- Lower- to middle-school pedagogy includes chanting, memory work, recitation, and structured memorization, consistent with the classical pedagogy toolkit (copybooks, liturgical/catechetical memory work, etc.).
- The school acknowledges a restorative/restful dimension (scholé) in some aspects of education, while still emphasizing rigorous, high-level study—an integration of contemplative/restful elements with rigorous inquiry.
- The program documents upper-school rhetoric training, speeches, and advanced linguistic work (Latin, classical studies), indicating a full engagement of rhetoric and public expression in the pedagogy.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: Socratic seminars; dialectic; memorization/recitation; chant/singing for memory; restfulness/scholé; rhetoric and oratory; annual public speaking opportunities.
- Negative indicators: No explicit exclusive reliance on experiential/project-based learning; the materials emphasize traditional, teacher-led, and memory-based classical pedagogy rather than a wholesale shift to student-led or project-based constructivism.

Why this rating

- ACCA demonstrates a comprehensive classical pedagogy: Socratic/seminal discourse for upper grades, chant/memory-based recitation for younger grades, and a rhetoric emphasis in high school. This is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Socratic method and upper-level rhetoric; memory/recitation and chant; scholé/restful learning language.

Element 5: School Faculty — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- The Academy describes its classes as being taught by “gifted teachers who are eager to share their knowledge and enthusiasm for learning,” indicating a skilled, virtuous faculty as the core of the living curriculum.
- Class sizes are intentionally small to facilitate close teacher-student engagement, a hallmark of classical pedagogy and mentorship culture.
- There are references to a faculty-wide emphasis on virtue and character formation, and the platform positions teachers as exemplars and mentors in a “living curriculum” sense.

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: model teachers; living curriculum; faculty as mentors; small class size; teacher-led instruction; teacher-student mentorship culture.
- Negative indicators: None evident in the materials reviewed; no mention of “facilitators on the side” or purely certification-driven pedagogy; rather, the faculty is framed as central to classical formation.

Why this rating

- The evidence consistently portrays the faculty as the core “living curriculum,” with a mentorship culture and small-class pedagogy typical of classical education. Therefore, Element 5 is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Faculty description and small-class rationale; “living curriculum” language.

Element 6: School Parents & Community — CLASSICAL

Evidence

- ACCA emphasizes a partnership with parents, with statements like “In partnership with parents and guided by the Gospel, the Academy strives to educate students...” and explicit calls for parent formation and engaging with the classical philosophy via book studies and gatherings.
- The PSP model frames parents as participants who support learning on at-home days (e.g., grading at-home work; not required to teach at home, but involved in grading). This explicitly positions parents as collaborative co-educators rather than passive clients.
- There are references to parent-facing content, book studies, and gatherings, designed to educate parents about classical education and to align with the school’s ethos.
- The school’s open-campus/visit ethos is reflected in enrollment and information pages, inviting parent engagement and involvement in school life (PSP operations and calendar postings).

Positive/Negative keyword analysis

- Positive indicators present: partnership with parents; parent formation; book studies; family involvement in classical education; open-campus/visit invitations.
- Negative indicators: None clearly evident; the materials emphasize collaboration rather than consumer-model language (which is listed in the lexicon as a potential negative signal). Public materials emphasize partnership rather than consumerism.

Why this rating

- ACCA foregrounds a genuine partnership with parents, with explicit opportunities for parent formation and participation in the learning process, consistent with CLASSICAL expectations for parental engagement. Therefore, Element 6 is CLASSICAL.

Citations: Partnership with parents language; PSP-family roles; parent-formation content; open-campus references.

Overall Ranking and Synthesis

- Element 1 — Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL
- Element 2 — School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL
- Element 3 — Curriculum: CLASSICAL
- Element 4 — Pedagogy: CLASSICAL
- Element 5 — Faculty: CLASSICAL
- Element 6 — Parents & Community: CLASSICAL

Aggregate classification: CLASSICAL

Rationale in brief: ACCA's public materials consistently present a Christian, theologically grounded framework; a Trivium-based, Great Books/western-civilization curriculum; a pedagogy that blends Socratic discussion with memorization and chant; a faculty described as mentors within a living-curriculum approach; and a strong partnership with parents within a PSP structure. The presence of doctrinal commitments, classical content, and explicit formation aims across all six categories aligns ACCA squarely with CLASSICAL education principles as defined by the Six Essential Elements rubric and associated keyword lexicon. See cited evidence for each category above.

General assessment: CLASSICAL

ABSTRACT

summary of the six primary categories

- Religious and Metaphysical Foundations: CLASSICAL — Christ-centered, Biblically rooted, creedal/theological framing; liturgical language present in motto and faith statements; communal practices implied through prayer and liturgical symbolism.
- School Purpose and Goal: CLASSICAL — Formation with virtue, wisdom, and rightly ordered love of Truth/Beauty/Goodness; teleology aligned with classical paideia and Great Books ethos; not primarily vocational preparation.
- Curriculum: CLASSICAL — Trivium-based progression; Great Books/Western civilization influence; Latin/Greek language emphasis; Memoria Press materials accompanying a robust classical core; history integrated as Western civilization study.
- Pedagogy: CLASSICAL — Socratic discussion for upper grades; memory work and chanting for younger grades; contemplative/restful elements (scholé) integrated with rigorous inquiry; rhetoric and public speaking opportunities in upper levels.
- Faculty: CLASSICAL — Living curriculum; small class sizes; teachers as mentors and exemplars; emphasis on virtuous pedagogy and mastery among faculty.
- Parents & Community: CLASSICAL — Strong partnership with parents; parent formation and inclusion in book studies; open-campus approach and flexible involvement via PSP.

What would move the needle (applies if SOMEWHAT CLASSICAL; not required here)

- Not applicable, as the aggregate is CLASSICAL. If a needle move were needed, typical steps would include explicit integration of Great Books discussions in more grade levels, formalized community

rituals/liturgical year events, or expanded community-service-oriented projects tied to virtue formation.

Appendix

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE DISCLAIMER

This audit was conducted using artificial intelligence tools (including large language models and automated web-analysis scripts) to evaluate the extent to which school websites reflect or incorporate recognized principles of classical education (e.g., the trivium, emphasis on truth/beauty/goodness, integration of great books, Latin/classical languages, Socratic method, rigorous academics, moral/character formation, etc.).

Important Limitations and Caveats

1. **Automated Nature:** The analysis relies on AI interpretation of publicly-accessible school website content as of the date of the audit. It does not involve direct contact with schools, review of internal documents, classroom observation, or verification of curriculum implementation beyond what is stated or implied on the website.
2. **Probabilistic Results:** Scores and assessments are probabilistic and reflect the AI's best interpretation of available text and site structure. They are not infallible and may miss nuance, context, or recent changes not yet reflected online.
3. **Subjectivity of Classical Education:** "Classical Education" encompasses a range of traditions and interpretations (e.g., Dorothy Sayers' trivium model, Classical Christian Education, Great Books programs, etc.). The Humanitas Institute Audit of the Six Elements of Classical Education uses a broad, consensus-based framework derived from prominent classical education organizations and thought leaders. Reasonable people may disagree on weighting or inclusion of specific criteria.
4. **No Official Endorsement or Certification:** Results do not constitute official endorsement, accreditation, or certification by any classical education organization. They are provided for informational and research purposes only.
5. **Potential for Error:** Websites may be incomplete, poorly worded, or temporarily inaccurate. Conversely, sophisticated marketing language may create false positives. Human review by parents, educators, or classical education experts is strongly recommended before drawing final conclusions about any school.
6. **Data Privacy and Ethics:** Only publicly available information was analyzed. No attempts were made to access password-protected areas or collect personal data.
7. **No Liability:** The authors, developers, and distributors of this audit assume no liability for decisions made on the basis of these results. Users are solely responsible for their own due diligence.

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